

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

compare-code

Two fenced code blocks side-by-side, each with a label.

Before and after, the diff you can read aloud.

BEFORE · ONE QUERY PER ROW

```
const signals = await db.signals.findAll();
for (const s of signals) {
  s.owner = await db.users.find(s.ownerId);
}
return signals;
```

AFTER · ONE BATCHED JOIN

```
const signals = await db.signals.findAll({
  include: { owner: true },
});
return signals;
```

Ten lines a side is the ceiling.

BEFORE · AT THE PANE BUDGET

```
function beforePane(rows) {  
  const out = [];  
  for (const row of rows) {  
    // ten lines per pane is the most  
    // a side-by-side diff can hold  
    // before the type drops below  
    // back-row legibility  
    out.push(transform(row));  
  }  
  return out;  
}
```

AFTER · SAME BUDGET, SAME SHAPE

```
function afterPane(rows) {  
  // the panes must stay line-comparable:  
  // the eye pairs line N with line N  
  // across the gutter – pad or trim  
  // until the shapes align  
  return rows.map(transform);  
}  
// past ten lines a side, split the  
// comparison across two slides
```

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When NOT to reach for compare-code.

One side is prose

If one column is code and the other is description, use a single fenced block with surrounding prose. `compare-code` is for code-versus-code.

Snippets longer than 14 lines

The text shrinks below readability past 14 lines per side. Split into two slides or extract the key delta into a smaller diff.

Three-way comparison

`compare-code` is binary. For three configurations or three implementations, use prose with successive fenced blocks or a `compare-table`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`compare-prose` — the change is state, not code

`redline` — the comparison is prose-versus-prose

`redline` — the change is in verbatim text or legal language

`compare-table` — three or more variants on shared dimensions